

as exploring avenues to increase your income if it truly is keeping you trapped in a lifestyle that's not making you happy, is to actually acknowledge the way that you're feeling. Being undervalued by your employer, whether in the private sector or the public sector (which, according to teacher friends of mine, actually feels a lot like being undervalued by society itself) is not something that remains at the office. You carry it with you into your home, into your sense of wellbeing and into your habits with money.

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I'd like you to start thinking about your relationship with work and earning, and how it feeds into your wider relationship with money. Do you earn a salary, are you self-employed, or both? Do you see money earned as a side-hustle or passion project in a different light to how you see a salaried income? Has your income changed over the last few years, and has your attitude towards the money that you're earning shifted in line with that? Sometimes, as we start to progress in our careers and make more money, we start to feel a sense of guilt or of being undeserving – does that resonate with you? Or perhaps you've spent years feeling underpaid and overworked – is this something that affects how you feel about money? In order to achieve a full sense of financial wellbeing, these are things that we need to unpack and work through. Again, I recommend getting something down on paper here; writing can be magical, in that sometimes our true feelings seem to bypass our conscious thoughts and end up on the paper almost by themselves,